

**KANSAS**

1861

The flag of Kansas follows a very common seal and name pattern. The original flag of 1925 had the seal, recalling settlement and agriculture, and a sunflower—the state flower. The name was added in 1963.

**LOUISIANA**

1812

The pelican, representing self-sacrifice and the state's role as a protector, has long been the badge of Louisiana, but the flag was only adopted in 1912 and slightly modified in 2004. The Acadians or "Cajuns" also have their own flag.

**MARYLAND**

1788

This is the only flag which is a true heraldic banner, reproducing the arms of the Baltimore family, once the "proprietors" of the state. Each side of the family is represented by two quarters. It was adopted in 1904.

**MICHIGAN**

1837

The arms was adopted in 1832, and placed on a blue field to make the state flag in 1911. The mottoes mean "I will defend," and "If you seek a pleasant peninsula, look about you."

**KENTUCKY**

1792

Another flag derived from the militia colors. The flag was adopted in 1918 and regularized in 1962. Like many state flags it contains the seal, the state name and a wreath of goldenrod, the state flower.

**MAINE**

1820

The flag dates from 1909 when the arms, adopted in 1820, were placed on a blue field. The star and motto recall Maine's northerly location. It was the northernmost state of the union, until Michigan joined in 1837.

**MASSACHUSETTS**

1788

The flag was originally adopted in 1908 and revised in 1971, replacing a pine tree with the coat of arms adopted in 1780. The arms, depicting a Native American holding a bow, now appears on both sides of the flag.

**MINNESOTA**

1858

The motto on this flag "The North Star," was retained from when the state was the northernmost in the Union. The flag was originally adopted in 1893 and revised in 1957.